

Global North and Global South discourses in news reporting

The Global North and the Global South are terms that describe unequal positions within the modern world system that arose from colonial expansion and capitalist development (Dados and Connell 2012), with the former associated with capitalist powers and the latter with oppressed nations. As such, the Global South refers to regions such as Latin America, Africa, and Asia that have been historically exploited. The term builds on earlier formulations, such as 'Third World' in the late twentieth century (Pinheiro 2024). In this sense, the term Global South does not describe economic underdevelopment alone, but names a historical pattern of domination through which exploitation has been produced and maintained at different levels, including the kinds of knowledge that are deemed legitimate (Santos 2015). The goal of the current study is twofold: (1) to collect a corpus of news reporting that represents Global North and Global South news, and (2) to explore the corpus by carrying an investigation of the discourses around a divisive issue between the Global North and Global South. We hope to show that the division is both (a) ideological and (b) marked by distinct discourses. Mass media in the Global North controls information flow around the world, defining what is reported and what is omitted, much as a propaganda model (Herman and Chomsky 1988) consisting of five filters: ownership, advertising, sourcing, flak, and ideology, which work together to ensure that news coverage defends Global North interests. To achieve the first goal, the study constructs a corpus divided into two sections. The Global South section includes such news sources as *China Daily* (China), *TASS* (Russia), *Tehran Times* (Iran), *The South African* and *News24* (South Africa), and *Al Jazeera* (Qatar). The Global North section comprises sources as *The New York Times* and *The Washington Post* (United States), *The Times* and *The Guardian* (United Kingdom), *The Globe and Mail* and *National Observer* (Canada), *Haaretz* (Israel), and *The Australian* and *The Sydney Morning Herald* (Australia). All texts are news reports written in English and are collected through web scraping and through extraction from the NOW Corpus. To meet the second goal, the analysis focuses on coverage of the war in Palestine. Relevant texts are selected from the corpus and analyzed using Lexical Multidimensional Analysis (LMDA; Berber Sardinha and Fitzsimmons-Doolan 2025). LMDA extends the original Multidimensional Analysis framework introduced by Biber (1988), by relying exclusively on lexical variables. The texts are tagged for POS and lemmatized; content words are extracted, and key lemmas are identified by comparing the frequency of each lemma in one corpus section (Global North or South) against the other. Counts are taken for each key lemma and entered in a factor analysis. The resulting factors are interpreted as discourse dimensions. The resulting dimensions are interpreted as macro-level discursive constructs that distinguish between differing ideologies in the Global North and South. The dimensions will be introduced and discussed in the paper presentation.

References

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